



he runs to his potential and leaves nothing behind on the track at the Stade de France.

Another star looking to make up for past letdowns will be Murali Sreeshankar. The long jumper had a tough time building up to the Tokyo Olympics and had to prove his fitness before he could compete in the Japanese capital. Although Sreeshankar has shown significant improvement in the last couple of years, clearing eight metres on seven of the 12 times he competed last year, including winning silver at the Asian Championships (8.37m) and

Asian Games (8.19m), he still has a blemish in his record. At the Budapest World Championships, which was one of the highest-profile competitions of the last season, Sreeshankar produced his worst performance (7.74m) since the Tokyo Olympics (7.69m). As they head towards Paris, both Sreeshankar and Sable will be looking to eliminate this blotch on their otherwise spotless list of achievements.

Meanwhile, another set of India's top contenders will have their sights trained on the 2024 World Athletics Relays Championships in the

Leading the pack: In 2023, Neeraj Chopra became the first Indian to win a gold at the Worlds. GETTY IMAGES



Highlights of 2023

Men

Neeraj Chopra became the first Indian to win a gold medal at the World Championships, winning gold in the javelin throw at the **2023** World Championships in Budapest

India qualified three athletes into the final of a World championships for the first time when Neeraj Chopra, Manu DP and Kishore Jena reached the finals of the men's javelin throw in Budapest India achieved its best ever result on the track at the World Championships when the **4x400m** relay team finished fifth in the Budapest World Championships. Neeraj Chopra and Kishore Jena completed a historic **1-2** finish in the men's javelin throw competition at the Asian games in Hangzhou

Women

Annu Rani became the first Indian to win gold in the women's javelin throw at the Asian Games beating among others China's Olympic champion Liu Shiying at Hangzhou